

PORTAL QA · ROUND 4

Templates page audit

May 13, 2026

Re-run of the Templates page audit. 9 findings — most carrying over from the previous Templates QA that still hadn't shipped (eyebrow active/archived split, Archived section, RESET TO DEFAULT + scrap USE TEMPLATE, kind-field free-text inline-edit, phase-subtitle migration, per-row category-chip drift), plus two fresh items from this round (brief-field defaults aren't seeded; template detail icon uses a tinted square tile instead of a single-color glyph). Triage **FROM PREVIOUS QA** chips first — those are still-open items the dev has been sitting on across multiple rounds.

9 findings · 0 HIGH · 6 MED · 3 LOW · 0 INFO

Status legend: **HIGH** blocks scanning / breaks workflow · **MED** meaningful divergence · **LOW** polish · **INFO** matches or working as intended.

Each finding carries two chips. **Severity** (HIGH / MED / LOW / INFO) maps to impact. **History tag** (**FROM PREVIOUS QA** = carried over from prior QA, **NEW** = surfaced this round) shows which items the dev has been sitting on vs. fresh observations. **FROM PREVIOUS QA** items need triage first.

Header + left rail

LOW

FROM PREVIOUS QA

Header eyebrow shows one total count; the original splits active vs archived

Where to see: Top → Templates → top of the left rail, above the "Templates" title.

Portal: "23 TEMPLATES" — a single total count rolling active and archived together.

Original: "6 ACTIVE · 1 ARCHIVED" — two counts separated by a middle dot. Tells the owner at a glance how many templates are in active use vs parked, without scrolling the list.

Fix: Split the count: "<active> ACTIVE · <archived> ARCHIVED". Omit the archived half when the count is zero so a clean workspace reads as "6 ACTIVE" rather than "6 ACTIVE · 0 ARCHIVED".

LOW

FROM PREVIOUS QA

No "Archived" expandable section at the bottom of the template list

Where to see: Top → Templates → bottom of the left rail (below the active templates).

Portal: Active templates scroll to the bottom of the rail with no "Archived" affordance. There's no path to view, restore, or permanently delete archived templates from this surface.

Original: Bottom of the rail anchors a collapsed "■ ARCHIVED · <count>" row. Clicking it expands the archived list inline so the owner can scan them without navigating away. Each archived template carries an "Unarchive" action.

Fix: Add the collapsed Archived section + per-row Unarchive action. Pairs with the ARCHIVE button in the template header — the workflow only makes sense if archived templates have a visible home.

MED

FROM PREVIOUS QA

Template-row category chips only partially migrated; kinds drift across the catalog

Where to see: Top → Templates → each row in the left rail. Scan the small chips next to each template name and look for the ones still reading "general".

Portal: Most templates carry a chip but it doesn't always match the work: Brand Refresh = Brand, Content = Content, Creative/Design = design, Hosting/IT = web_dev, Organic Social Media = social — those land. Account Management, Email Marketing, Finance/Billing, HR/Resourcing all still read "general". One label ("mark edit test") is clearly leftover test data.

Original: Per-row chip pattern is a portal addition the original doesn't have — and that's fine, the addition is nicer for scanning the list. The issue is the chips that DO render carry wrong or placeholder values.

Fix: Two things:

- Migrate every built-in template to its correct kind. Account Management → "Account Management" (or whatever the workspace-curated kind catalog calls it), HR/Resourcing → "HR", etc. The "general" fallback should only land for user-created templates the owner hasn't categorised yet.
- Purge test data like "mark edit test" from the seeded kind catalog before Operations sees it.

Template detail (right pane)

MED

FROM PREVIOUS QA

Scrap the **USE TEMPLATE** button and restore **RESET TO DEFAULT** in its slot

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any built-in template → top-right of the detail header between the "Click any field to edit" pill and ARCHIVE. Try Account Management first — Brand Refresh already shows **RESET TO DEFAULT**, but Account Management has **USE TEMPLATE** in that slot.

Portal: Renders an **USE TEMPLATE** button in the header. Tooltip says "Apply this template's phases to a project" — vague about target, conflict handling, undo. The dev added this as a new feature; it doesn't exist on the original at all. **RESET TO DEFAULT** renders on Brand Refresh but is missing on Account Management (and likely other built-ins) — those templates can't be reverted after an accidental edit.

Original: Header carries **RESET TO DEFAULT** in the slot portal uses for **USE TEMPLATE**, plus **ARCHIVE**. **RESET** restores the built-in's factory state — original phases, subtasks, onboarding checklist, brief fields — wiping any edits since seed. Only renders on built-in templates; user-created templates have no factory baseline to reset to, so the button hides on those. Click triggers a confirm dialog naming exactly what gets overwritten.

Fix: Two-part fix:

- **Scrap the **USE TEMPLATE** button entirely.** It's the wrong function for this slot. Apply-to-a-project (if Operations wants that feature) belongs on a different surface, not the template header.
- **Render **RESET TO DEFAULT** on every built-in template's header**, not just Brand Refresh. Verify the workspace seed marks each built-in (Account Management, Web Design — Full Stack, SEO Retainer — Monthly, Content, etc.) so the button can render conditionally. Hide on user-created templates. Confirm dialog wording: "Reset <name> to its factory state? All edits since the template was seeded will be lost. This cannot be undone."

MED

FROM PREVIOUS QA

Kind field uses a fixed-catalog dropdown; the original is free-text inline-edit

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any template → click the kind pill in the detail header. Test in both light and dark mode.

Portal: Clicking the kind pill opens a dropdown with 6 fixed options (Web Development, SEO, Content, Brand, Paid Media, Custom). This is why Account Management currently reads "Web Development" — there's no right option in the dropdown for it. The dropdown also contradicts the ↓ *Click any field to edit* hint elsewhere on the header, which promises inline-edit but this field doesn't behave that way.

Original: Kind is a free-text inline-editable input. Click the field → it becomes a text input pre-filled with the current value → type anything that fits the work (Account Management, HR / Resourcing, Hosting & IT, etc.) → Enter or blur saves. No fixed catalog. The icon next to kind stays as a visual cue, but the text is free-form.

Fix: Replace the dropdown with an inline-edit text input matching the house pattern used by every other editable field on the template detail. Click → text input → type → Enter/blur → save. Keep the icon for visual continuity but make the label free-form.

MED

NEW

"**+ New template**" opens a required-fields modal; the original creates inline **+** drops into the editor

Where to see: Top → Templates → click **+ New template** in the top-right of the left rail.

Portal: Opens a modal titled **New template** with two required text inputs (Name + Kind) and **Cancel** / **Create** footer buttons. The user can't proceed without filling both fields upfront. Bonus regression on the Create button: it renders solid **coral/red** — the danger colour, not brand-blue — so the most additive action on the page reads as destructive.

Original: No modal. Clicking **+ New template** creates a blank "New template" entry immediately, selects it in the rail, and drops the user into the right-pane editor where every field is inline-editable (name, kind, phases, onboarding checklist, brief fields). Same pattern Notes uses on the client detail: click "+ New note" → blank draft appears in the list → start typing. No upfront commit, no required fields, no second click.

Fix: Three changes:

- **Drop the modal.** Click on **+ New template** creates a blank entry with default name "*New template*" and default kind "*general*" (or whatever the catalog fallback is), selects it, and focuses the right-pane name field for instant rename.
- **Inline-edit everything.** Same house pattern the rest of the page uses for phase names, kind, etc. No required-field gate.
- **Fix the Create button colour** if the modal stays for any reason: solid coral/red violates the four-tier blue-highlight hierarchy (coral is reserved for destructive confirms). Brand-blue *--highlight* is the right token.

MED

FROM PREVIOUS QA

Phase subtitle template-aware migration is partial

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any template → detail header → line between the icon and the kind chip.

Portal: Brand Refresh shows a custom subtitle: *"One-time engagement, roughly 8-12 weeks."* Account Management still shows the generic placeholder *"Describe how this template's phases are paced."* Wiring exists; data hasn't been migrated across the seeded templates.

Original: Every built-in template ships with a custom subtitle describing pacing + engagement shape, so the operator gets useful context at a glance instead of placeholder copy.

Fix: Two paths:

- **Per-template subtitles** — migrate each unmigrated template (Account Management, Email Marketing, etc.) with hand-written copy.
- **Kind-driven subtitles** — derive the line from the template's kind so all templates of the same kind share a default subtitle. Lower maintenance, but less specificity per template.

Either way, eliminate the placeholder string from the live header.

MED

NEW

Brief-field defaults aren't seeded on new templates

Where to see: Top → Templates → select a template → scroll to the PROJECT BRIEF FIELDS section near the bottom.

Portal: Section renders the title + subtitle + **+ Add field** button only. No starter chips. The Account Management template ships with zero brief fields even though brief fields are the primary way a kanban board's brief panel gets populated.

Original: Every built-in template seeds a sensible set of brief fields the AM can prune or extend: *Goals · Target audience · Success metrics · Competitors · Must-keep features · Out of scope · Timeline milestones* for a Web Design template; different sets per service type. The chips render in a wrapping row above the **+ Add field** button.

Fix: Seed each built-in template with brief-field defaults that fit its service type. The chips need to actually save to the template + flow to the kanban board's brief panel on service creation — without that, a fresh service starts with an empty brief and the AM has to recreate the same seven fields every time.

LOW

NEW

Template-tile icon: portal uses a tinted square; the original uses a single-color glyph

Where to see: Top → Templates → top-left of the right pane, next to the template's title.

Portal: Large square tile (~56px) with a tinted background matching the template's category colour, holding a centered icon (trending-arrow for SEO, etc.). High visual weight — competes with the template title for attention.

Original: Smaller icon (~28px) with no background, rendered in *--text-soft*. Lives left of the title at ascender height so the title anchors the row. Visual hierarchy: title wins, icon supports.

Fix: Match the original — drop the tinted-tile treatment and render the icon at the smaller single-color size. The category colour can live on the chip in the left-rail list (if the chip pattern survives the decision above); the right-pane icon should stay neutral so the title is the focal point of the detail view.

Build checklist

Every actionable finding (HIGH / MED / LOW). INFO items are listed in the body but not in the checklist. Tick each as it ships.

- ☐ **LOW** **Header eyebrow shows one total count; the original splits active vs archived**
Split the count: "<active> ACTIVE · <archived> ARCHIVED". Omit the archived half when the count is zero so a clean workspace reads as "6 ACTIVE" rather than "6 ACTIVE · 0 ARCHIVED".
- ☐ **LOW** **No "Archived" expandable section at the bottom of the template list**
Add the collapsed Archived section + per-row Unarchive action. Pairs with the ARCHIVE button in the template header — the workflow only makes sense if archived templates have a visible home.
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Two things:
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 - Purge test data like "mark edit test" from the seeded kind catalog before Operations sees it.
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Two-part fix:
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